

SKILLS GUIDE



The ability to generate lots of ideas and translate them into viable sketches, designs, and products.



Strong numerical skills for setting dimensions and scale in patterns, and calculating production costs.



Effective communication skills for interacting with design teams and conveying ideas clearly.



Strong market awareness and business skills, especially for self-employed designers.



Strong computer skills for working on Computer-aided Design (CAD) software and other applications.



TECHNICAL DESIGNER Bridges the gap between fashion house designers and manufacturers, focusing on producing patterns that make the most economical use of fabric, and are cost-effective and easy to manufacture.



FASHION STYLIST Advises individuals on fashion. Stylists are typically employed within the modeling, photography, and film industries.



FASHION BUYER Works for retail stores, purchasing stock to sell to the store's customers. Because buyers usually purchase merchandise several months in advance, they must be able to anticipate trends in fashion to meet future demand.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Art • Fashion • Craft and design • Sewing • Computer-aided Design (CAD) • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A degree-level qualification in fashion, art, or design is helpful. However, a strong portfolio of work is a must.



LIFESTYLE People in the fashion industry usually work long hours. Weekends are required in the lead-up to fashion shows and other launches.



LOCATION The role is based in a studio or workshop. Fashion designers may have to travel abroad to attend fashion shows and fairs.



THE REALITIES A fashion designer's work is often subject to harsh criticism. Deadlines are tight, especially when they are preparing a new collection.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **COSTUME DESIGNER** Designs clothes and accessories that actors wear in plays or films. These outfits need to be appropriate for the characters in a production and suit the period or fictional world in which the play or film is set.
- ▶ **DRESSMAKER/TAILOR** Creates made-to-measure items of clothing for customers, and usually runs small independent businesses, specializing in a particular type of clothing, such as customized suits or bridal wear.
- ▶ **FASHION MODEL** Models clothes in order to promote fashion lines to customers and the media. Models appear in fashion shows or in photographs for catalogs, magazines, newspapers, and advertising campaigns.